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Unit 3 Assignment

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Evaluation of Professional Emails

Introduction

Email is one of the most common forms of communication in the workplace. Although writing an email may seem simple, the way an email is written can affect how a person is understood and how professionally the sender is perceived. An effective professional email should be clear, concise, organized, respectful, and appropriate for its audience. Business writing also needs to be organized so that readers can understand the message without unnecessary effort (LibreTexts, 2024). Similarly, Last (2022) explains that professional emails should use an appropriate salutation, a clear subject line, concise paragraphs, correct grammar, and a professional tone.

For this assignment, I selected two hypothetical professional emails for analysis. The first is an exemplary email that demonstrates effective workplace communication. The second is a problematic email containing several weaknesses. Comparing these messages shows how small choices in written communication can make a significant difference in workplace effectiveness.

Email 1: Exemplary Professional Email

Subject: Project Report Submission – September 20

Dear Ms. Ahmed,

I have attached the completed project report for your review. The report includes the final analysis, results, and recommendations discussed during our last meeting.

Please let me know if you would like me to make any revisions or provide additional information. I would be happy to address any questions.

Best regards,

Muhammad Ali

Evaluation of the Exemplary Email

The first strength of this email is its subject line. “Project Report Submission – September 20” is specific and immediately tells the recipient what the email concerns. A clear subject line helps readers understand the purpose of an email before opening it, which is an important part of professional email etiquette (Last, 2022).

The greeting and closing are also appropriate. “Dear Ms. Ahmed” establishes a respectful professional tone, while “Best regards” provides a polite closing. The sender's name is included, making the identity of the sender clear.

The tone is respectful and professional without sounding overly formal. The writer does not use slang, unnecessary abbreviations, or demanding language. This is important because written communication can sometimes be interpreted differently from spoken communication. Last (2022) notes that professionals should consider their audience and check their tone before sending digital communication.

The email is also concise. The writer communicates the purpose, identifies what is attached, and explains what the recipient should do next without adding unnecessary background information. The information is organized logically, which supports the principle that organization is essential for clear business writing (LibreTexts, 2024).

The grammar and spelling are correct, and the sentences are easy to understand. The email also mentions the attachment directly, which reduces the possibility that the recipient will overlook it. The formatting uses short paragraphs, making the message easy to read.

Regarding privacy, the email does not include unnecessary personal or confidential information. The message is directed to one recipient rather than being unnecessarily distributed to a large group. This demonstrates awareness that workplace communication should respect privacy and the intended audience.

Finally, the email supports timely communication by presenting the report clearly and inviting the recipient to respond if revisions are needed. Overall, these strengths make the email efficient, respectful, and easy to act upon.

Email 2: Problematic Professional Email

Subject: IMPORTANT!!!

Hey,

I need the report. I told you about it before and I need it ASAP because the meeting is coming up. Please send it today!!! Also, make sure you check everything because last time there were mistakes. Send it to everyone on the team.

Thanks

Critical Evaluation of the Problematic Email

The second email has several weaknesses. The subject line, “IMPORTANT!!!,” is vague and overly emphatic. It does not tell the recipient what the email is actually about. A better subject would identify the requested document and deadline.

The greeting is also too informal for many professional situations. “Hey” may be appropriate between close colleagues, but a more professional greeting would be preferable when communicating with a supervisor, client, instructor, or unfamiliar colleague.

The biggest problem is the tone. Statements such as “I told you about it before” and “I need it ASAP” can sound impatient or blaming. The multiple exclamation marks further increase the emotional tone. Professional communication should remain respectful and constructive, even when the request is urgent.

The email is relatively short, but it is not necessarily concise in an effective sense. Conciseness means communicating efficiently while still providing the information the reader needs. This message does not provide a precise deadline, explain which report is required, or clearly identify what action the recipient should take. Therefore, its brevity actually creates ambiguity.

There are also formatting and grammar concerns. The message uses informal language, lacks a professional closing, and does not provide the sender's full name or other identifying information. The phrase “send it to everyone on the team” is also unclear because the email does not identify the team or recipients.

The privacy issue is particularly important. Asking the recipient to “send it to everyone” without identifying the appropriate recipients could result in unnecessary disclosure of information. Professional email etiquette requires careful consideration of recipients and discourages unnecessary use of “Reply All” or broad distribution (Last, 2022).

Finally, the message does not establish a clear timeliness expectation. Although “today” and “ASAP” suggest urgency, neither provides a precise deadline. A specific time would make the request easier to understand and act upon.

Recommendations for Improvement

The problematic email could be improved by replacing the vague subject line with something specific, such as **“Request for Project Report – September 18.”** The greeting should also be changed to a professional form such as “Dear [Name].”

The writer should replace demanding language with a respectful request. Instead of saying, “I need it ASAP,” the writer could say, “Could you please send the final report by 4:00 p.m. today? We need it for tomorrow’s meeting.”

The email should also explain exactly which report is required and identify the appropriate recipients if sharing is necessary. If the report contains sensitive information, the sender should verify that everyone receiving it is authorized to access it.

Finally, the writer should proofread the message, use short paragraphs, and include a professional closing and full name. These changes would make the request clearer, reduce the possibility of misunderstanding, and create a more respectful professional impression. They also reflect the guidance to keep business emails brief, well formatted, reviewed for errors, and appropriately addressed (Last, 2022).

Conclusion

The comparison of these two emails demonstrates that effective professional communication involves much more than simply transferring information. The exemplary email succeeds because it has a clear subject line, professional greeting and closing, respectful tone, concise content, correct grammar, readable formatting, appropriate privacy considerations, and a clear purpose. In contrast, the problematic email creates uncertainty through its vague subject line, informal and demanding tone, unclear deadline, weak formatting, and potentially inappropriate distribution of information.

Effective email etiquette helps employees communicate with clarity while also showing respect for colleagues and protecting professional relationships. In my view, the most important lesson is that every email should be written from the reader's perspective. Before clicking “send,” a professional writer should ask whether the message is clear, necessary, respectful, complete, and directed to the right people. Careful attention to these details can prevent misunderstandings and make workplace communication more efficient and professional.

References

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